

A: Maharashtra ranks first in manufacturing gross value added, with 15.95% share of the country's total, anchored by automotive, defence, pharmaceutical and data centres.

The state is developing dedicated projects in every region—steel city in Gadchiroli and Chandrapur, Aurangabad Industrial Township Ltd (AURIC) in Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar, pharma city in Raigad, an electronics cluster in Pune, the PM MITRA Textile Park in Amravati, a leather cluster in Raigad, and the upcoming Dighi Port Industrial Area. The state is also developing three dedicated defence corridors spanning Pune–Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar–Ahilyanagar, Nagpur–Wardha–Amravati–Saoner, and Nashik–Dhule. Maharashtra was recognised as a top achiever in key reform areas under the Centre's Business Reforms Action Plan 2024.

Global manufacturers have responded with capital. Maharashtra leads every other state under the PLI Scheme, with 85 units in automobile and auto components, 41 in food products, 22 in white goods, and 19 in specialty steel. Overall, Maharashtra has over 240 PLI-approved manufacturing units.

32 | The Maharashtra Industrial Development Corporation (MIDC) is the direct link between government and industry, handling land acquisition and disposal, and giving investors a one-stop point for investor relations across over 143 large industrial areas and 108 mini-industrial areas.

Additionally, AURIC exemplifies what institutional depth can build. A special purpose vehicle formed as a joint venture between National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation and MIDC, AURIC spans 10,000 acres in Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar. It has attracted investment commitments of over ₹92,000 crore and generated around 55,000 jobs. It is India's first greenfield smart industrial city built on a walk-to-work, plug-and-play model, ICT-

“We are establishing a dedicated Commissionerate of MSME under the Department of Industries, Investment & Services”



enabled, powered by 24x7 reliable and cost-effective electricity.

The Dighi Port Industrial Area, being developed over 15,000 acres in Raigad district, is envisioned as a major port-led industrial hub catering to sectors such as engineering, food & beverage, pharmaceuticals, logistics, and allied manufacturing industries. The MAITRI Act, 2023, gives investors time-bound, legally enforceable clearances, backed by an AI chatbot, an instant incentive calculator, a step-by-step investor wizard, a 24x7 toll-free call centre, a real-time tracking dashboard, a secure entity locker, and a fully paperless digital verification process.

We are establishing a dedicated Commissionerate of MSME under the Department of Industries, Investment & Services. It will be the nodal mechanism for MSME policy, credit access, innovation and grievance resolution.

Q: How key are mega infrastructure developments like Mumbai-Nagpur Samruddhi Expressway and Vadhavan port to boosting the state's industrial landscape?